

for 32 bit and a massive 40 GB for 64-bit variant as its minimum.)

- DirectX 9 graphics device with WDDM 1.0 or higher driver (Again, it's the same as Vista's. XP with its modest graphics just required a Super VGA graphics device.)
- Additional requirements to use certain features:
- Internet access
- Depending on resolution, video playback may require additional memory and advanced graphics hardware
- For some Windows Media Center functionality a TV tuner and additional hardware may be required
- Windows Touch and Tablet PCs require specific hardware
- HomeGroup requires a network and PCs running Windows 7
- DVD/CD authoring requires a compatible optical drive
- BitLocker requires Trusted Platform Module (TPM) 1.2
- BitLocker To Go requires a USB flash drive
- Windows XP Mode requires an additional 1 GB of RAM, an additional 15 GB of available hard disk space, and a processor capable of hardware virtualization with Intel VT or AMD-V turned on
- Music and sound require audio output

We saw how it compares with Vista and XP and even though its an upgrade to Vista, system requirements haven't increased at all. We've even tested Windows 7 on a machine with 1.6 Ghz Intel Celeron processor and 512 MB RAM with 32 MB shared for Video Memory and it seemed pretty usable for most basic tasks. Even though almost the entire ram was used all the time, working on multiple tabs in Firefox, word processing and music playback simultaneously was not outright painful. While that system handles Windows XP fairly well, Vista just kills it and renders it unusable even for internet browsing.

We, however, do not recommend you to install Windows 7 on anything lesser than 1GB RAM but you can give it a spin if you intend to use your computer as a netbook and all of your hardware is compatible. You can check that with a handy utility called the Windows 7 Upgrade Advisor which we shall be talking about next. Its like a 'First Things First' before you get down to installing Windows 7 or even considering it for your computer if your machine doesn't boast of the latest hardware and all the RAM you will ever need.

## 1.6 Windows 7 Upgrade Advisor

Microsoft provides this really handy tool called "Windows 7 Upgrade